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Manual Chapter : Configuring a Simple Intranet

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Configuring a Simple Intranet

Overview: A simple intranet configuration

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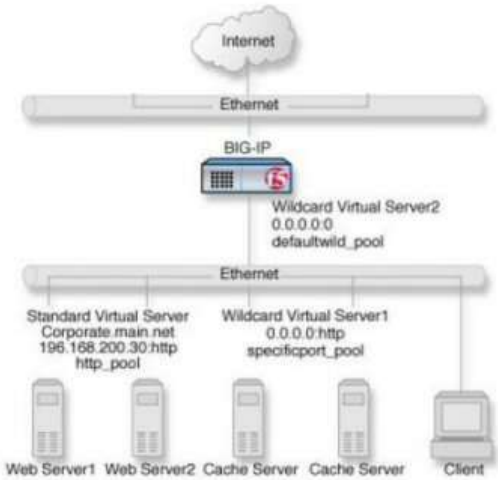
The simple intranet implementation is commonly found in a corporate intranet (see the following illustration). In this implementation, the BIG-IP system performs load balancing for several different types of connection requests:

- HTTP connections to the company's intranet web site. The BIG-IP system load balances the two web servers that host the corporate intranet web site, `Corporate.main.net`.
- HTTP connections to Internet content. These are handled through a pair of cache servers that are also load balanced by the BIG-IP system.
- Non-HTTP connections to the Internet.

Non-intranet connections



As the illustration shows, the non-intranet connections are handled by wildcard virtual servers; that is, servers with the IP address `0.0.0.0`. The wildcard virtual server that is handling traffic to the cache servers is port specific, specifying port `80` for HTTP requests. As a result, all HTTP requests not matching an IP address on the intranet are directed to the cache server. The wildcard virtual server handling non-HTTP requests is a default wildcard server. A default wildcard virtual server is one that uses only port `0`. This makes it a catch-all match for outgoing traffic that does not match any standard virtual server or any port-specific wildcard virtual server.

Creating a pool

You can create pool of servers that you group together to receive and process traffic, to enable the BIG-IP system to efficiently distribute the load on servers.

1. On the Main tab, click **Local Traffic › Pools** .
   The Pool List screen opens.
2. Click **Create**.
   The New Pool screen opens.
3. In the **Name** field, type a unique name for the pool.
4. In the Resources area of the screen, use the **New Members** setting to add the pool members.

   For example, the pool members for `http_pool` are `192.168.100.10:80` and `192.168.100.11:80`. The pool members for `specificport_pool` are `192.168.100.20:80` and `192.168.100.21:80`.
5. Click **Finished**.

The load balancing pool appears in the Pools list.

Create a virtual server for application traffic

This task creates a destination IP address for application traffic. As part of this task, you must assign the relevant pool to the virtual server.

1. On the Main tab, click **Local Traffic › Virtual Servers** .
   The Virtual Server List screen opens.
2. Click **Create**.
   The New Virtual Server screen opens.
3. In the **Name** field, type a unique name for the virtual server.
4. For a host, in the **Destination Address/Mask** field, type an IPv4 or IPv6 address in CIDR format to allow all traffic to be translated.

   The supported format is address/prefix, where the prefix length is in bits. For example, an IPv4 address/prefix is `0.0.0.0/0`, and an IPv6 address/prefix is `::/0`.
5. In the **Service Port** field, type `80`, or select **HTTP** from the list.
6. In the Configuration area of the screen, locate the **Type** setting and select either **Standard** or **Forwarding (IP)**.
7. From the **HTTP Profile** list, select an HTTP profile.
8. In the Resources area of the screen, from the **Default Pool** list, select the relevant pool name.
9. Click **Finished**.

You now have a virtual server to use as a destination address for application traffic.

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